Create Your Business Case for Enterprise Change Management (ECM)

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Use this template as a starting point to construct and customize your business case for developing enterprise change management capability by implementing "Project ECM." See Prosci's Example Business Case of Enterprise Change Management for more details.

Executive Summary Briefly summarize your overall business case for Project ECM. (Hint: Complete this section last.)	Example: In the coming years, no core competency will be more important than the ability to effectively implement change. With increasing internal and external pressures, our organization will only undertake more projects and initiatives. Our ability to achieve expected benefits and outcomes will be tied directly to how effectively we engage employees in these upcoming changes, as return on investment depends on employee adoption and usage. By building an organizational change management capability with the ECM Project, we will realize greater return on the initiatives we launch and position ourselves for success in the present and the future.
Problem Statement In one or two sentences, describe the unique problem your organization needs to solve by developing an enterprise change capability through Project ECM.	Example: Our organization needs to be successful with projects and initiatives that depend on high rates of adoption and usage. Unless we develop enterprise change management capability through Project ECM, achieving this goal will be difficult or impossible.
Situation Analysis Customize this section to reflect the relevant internal and external issues your unique organization faces. (Optional: add a SWOT analysis.)	Example: The time to build an organizational capability in change management is now. In upcoming years, we will face more change than ever before. We are already suffering the consequences of change saturation, and a change management capability can help increase our capacity to handle new change. Industry data suggests that 70% of change initiatives fail to deliver. One key source of this failure is that we do not pay adequate attention to employee adoption and usage. We have experienced the costs of not managing change and cannot afford to put at risk the changes we are about to embark upon.

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Alternative 1

A credible argument acknowledges opposing views. Strengthen your business case by describing at least one alternative to Project ECM. Discuss the pros and cons of choosing this solution instead of Project ECM. Use data to substantiate each assertion, when possible.

Example: Apply only project management to critical projects and initiatives.

Pros	Cons
Example: The technical side of the change is addressed	Example: Projects and initiatives less likely to meet objectives, or be on time or on budget
	Example: Change saturation and fatigue not addressed
	Example: Adoption and usage left to chance.
	Example: The people-dependent portion of ROI left to chance
	Example: Employee resistance will occur and will not be addressed

Alternative 2

Example: Apply only communications and training to critical projects and initiatives.

Pros	Cons
Example: Communications shared to advise employees when changes are coming via X channels	Example: Projects and initiatives less likely to meet objectives, or be on time or on budget
Example: Employees receive X training to learn how to use the change	Example: Employee resistance will occur and will not be addressed
	Example: One-way information flow (i.e., no feedback)
	Example: Change saturation and fatigue not addressed
	Example: Adoption and usage left to chance
	Example: The people-dependent portion of ROI left to chance

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Recommended Solution

Example: Our organization develops enterprise change capability via Project ECM.

Pros	Cons
Example: Effective communications advise employees at the right time, via the right channels and senders	Example: Requires investment (see cost-benefit analysis)
Example: Employees receive training to learn how to use the change, and how to execute their roles in change	Example: Requires structure, intent and resources
Example: Two-way communications (useful feedback)	Example: Requires active and visible executive sponsorship
Example: Meet project objectives (up to 6X more likely)	
Example: Achieve greater speed of adoption, ultimate utilization, and proficiency with changes	
Example: Mitigate change saturation and fatigue (resulting in higher satisfaction, lower turnover, etc.)	

Cost-Benefit Analysis

Share a high-level summary of your cost-benefit analysis or other analytical support for your recommended solution (i.e., Project ECM). Be sure to include the full analyses in the appendix of your final case report. For how-to instructions, refer to this article.

Change Management ROI Calculations

Use this section to share change management return on investment (CMROI) for multiple projects. For how-to instructions, refer to this article.

Project Name	Expected Project Benefits	Expected Benefits if Adoption and Usage = 0	People-Side Benefit Contribution

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Project ECM Implementation Plan

Provide an overview paragraph of your proposed implementation plan for Project ECM, including key ideas and rationale. Your goal is to make it clear why your proposed implementation plan is the best way to achieve your recommendation.

Additionally, include a simple table like the one below, flow charts, or a Gantt chart. Remember to communicate at the level of detail appropriate for your audience (i.e., executive, manager, team, etc.).

Add implementation overview here.

Phases	Tasks	Budget	Timeline

Get Feedback From Prosci

Need help strengthening your Business Case for ECM? Share your completed business case document with a Prosci solutions architect at solutions@prosci.com.

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